

Intuition Engine Programmer's Reference Guide

Preface

Intuition Engine is a modern 64-bit RISC machine: a re-imagining of Commodore/Atari/Sinclair/BBC/Amstrad/IBM 8/16/32-bit home-computer ideas from the 1980s and 1990s. It is built as an homage to that era of home computing, while remaining one Intuition Engine computer with a shared memory bus. Processors, video chips, sound engines, DMA hardware, file devices, input devices, and control registers all sit on the same backplane. When you move from VideoChip to VGA, or from SID to POKEY, or from IE64 to 6502, you are not changing computers. You are programming another card on the same bus.

This guide begins at the BASIC prompt because that is the quickest way to touch the machine. You will type short programs, inspect memory with PEEK, change hardware with POKE, and then use IE Mon to enter machine-code bytes directly. The examples are written for that path. They do not require an assembler, a build command, or a second machine to understand what is happening.

The book is also a reference. Chapter 2 is deliberately a vocabulary chapter, so skim it on a first reading and return to it when a keyword needs checking. The real climb continues in Chapter 3, where the screen becomes visible, then through sound, memory, processors, and I/O.

Keep one rule in mind as you read: every chip and every CPU is part of the same Intuition Engine.

Contents

Part I - Intuition Engine BASIC

1. BASIC Programming Rules
2. BASIC Language Vocabulary

Part II - Programming Graphics

3. Display Model Overview
4. VideoChip
5. VGA Text and Graphics Modes
6. TED Video
7. ANTIC and GTIA
8. ULA Display
9. Voodoo 3D Rasteriser
10. Tile and Sprite Layers from BASIC

Part III - Programming Sound and Music

11. Audio Architecture Overview
12. SoundChip and SFX
13. PSG and AY-3-8910
14. SN76489

15. SID Family
16. TED Audio
17. POKEY
18. AHX Engine
19. MOD Playback
20. WAV Sample Player
21. Paula DMA Engine
22. Music from BASIC and from each CPU

Part IV - BASIC to Machine Language

23. Memory Model and MMIO Map
24. IE64
25. IE32
26. 6502
27. Z80
28. M68K MC68020-Class
29. x86
30. Processor Timing, Traps, and Exceptions
31. Coprocessor and Cross-CPU Calls
32. IE Mon - the Machine Monitor
33. IE Script

Part V - Input / Output Guide

34. Disk and File I/O
35. The HOST Command
36. Keyboard, Mouse, Controller MMIO
37. Serial Devices

Appendices

- A. EhBASIC Keyword Abbreviations and Token Map
- B. Screen and Character Codes
- C. ASCII and CHR\$ Tables
- D. Per-Engine MMIO Maps
- E. Music Note and Frequency Tables
- F. Math and Derivative Helpers
- G. Per-CPU Opcode Quick Reference
- H. Per-CPU Symbol Index
- I. Error Message Index
- J. Full Memory Map
- K. Block Diagrams